

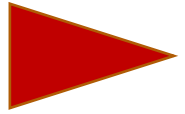
Introduction to Civics

Week 1

Rabia Zia

rabia.zia@nu.edu.pk





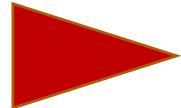
Whats is Civics?

- Civics is the study of the **rights** and **responsibilities** of citizens and **how government works**. It teaches people how to participate in their community and make decisions that benefit society. As such Civics is often referred to as the science of government or the science of politics.

It includes

- **Government:** How the government is structured and how it works
- **Laws:** The nature of law and civil law
- **Politics:** The political system and how citizens can participate in it
- **Citizenship:** The rights and responsibilities of citizens, and how they relate to the government
- **Civic engagement:** How citizens can participate in the public sphere to influence decision making





Purpose of Civics Education

To equip individuals with the knowledge, skills, and values needed for active participation in civic life.

Core Learning Areas

- Understanding the Constitution and its principles.
- Learning about the electoral process and voting rights.
- Exploring the justice system and its functioning.
- Examining public policies and their impact on society.
- Recognizing the role of civil society organizations in community development.

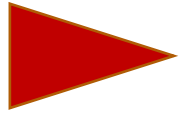
▶ Whats is Citizenship?

- Citizenship is the legal and social status of a person recognized as a member of a particular country or community, granting them rights, responsibilities, and a sense of belonging. It establishes a relationship between the individual and the state, based on mutual rights and obligations.

Key Features

- **Rights:** Includes voting, freedom of speech, legal protection, and access to public services.
- **Responsibilities:** Involves obeying laws, paying taxes, voting, and contributing to the welfare of the community.





Aspects of Citizenship with Rights & Responsibilities

1. Legal Aspect

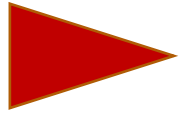
- Citizenship legally recognizes an individual as a member of a state, granting them certain protections and obligations under the law.

Rights

- **Protection by Law:** Citizens are entitled to protection from harm and fair treatment under the judicial system.
- **Access to Legal Documents:** Right to hold a passport, national ID, or other official documents.
- **Legal Assistance:** Access to government-provided legal aid and representation.

Responsibilities

- **Obedying Laws:** Citizens must follow the laws of the country, such as traffic rules or tax regulations.
- **Respecting Judicial Processes:** Abiding by court decisions and legal procedures.
- **Registering with Authorities:** Keeping official records, like registering births, marriages, or businesses.



Aspects of Citizenship with Rights & Responsibilities

2. Political Aspect

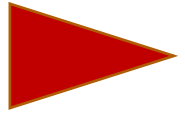
- Citizenship involves active participation in the political system to shape governance and policies.

Rights

- **Voting:** The right to vote in elections at local, regional, and national levels.
- **Running for Office:** The right to contest elections and hold public office.
- **Freedom of Political Expression:** The right to voice opinions and advocate for changes in policies or laws.

Responsibilities

- **Voting:** Actively participating in elections to ensure democratic representation.
- **Engaging in Political Discussions:** Staying informed and contributing to policy debates.
- **Upholding Democratic Values:** Supporting peaceful transitions of power and rejecting political violence.



Aspects of Citizenship with Rights & Responsibilities

3. Social Aspect

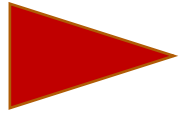
- Citizenship entails contributing to and being an active member of the community, fostering social harmony and welfare.

Rights

- **Access to Public Services:** Education, healthcare, and public facilities like parks and libraries.
- **Freedom of Association:** The right to join groups, clubs, or organizations.
- **Cultural Expression:** The right to practice and promote one's culture and traditions.

Responsibilities

- **Respecting Others:** Treating fellow citizens with dignity, regardless of differences in race, religion, or opinion.
- **Community Participation:** Volunteering or engaging in activities that improve the community, such as cleaning drives or charity work.
- **Promoting Unity:** Working to create an inclusive and cohesive society.



Aspects of Citizenship with Rights & Responsibilities

4. Economic Aspect

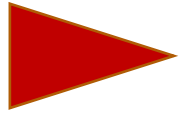
- Citizenship involves contributing to the economic stability and growth of the nation through productive activities.

Rights

- **Right to Work:** Citizens can pursue employment, start businesses, or engage in trade.
- **Economic Benefits:** Access to pensions, unemployment benefits, and other financial safety nets.
- **Fair Compensation:** The right to fair wages and safe working conditions.

Responsibilities

- **Paying Taxes:** Contributing to public funds for national development and infrastructure.
- **Using Resources Wisely:** Avoiding waste and ensuring sustainable use of natural and public resources.
- **Promoting Economic Growth:** Supporting local businesses and participating in the economy through productive activities.



Aspects of Citizenship with Rights & Responsibilities

5. Moral and Ethical Aspect

- Citizenship involves adhering to moral values and ethical behavior, promoting fairness, and standing against injustice.

Rights

- **Freedom of Conscience:** Citizens have the right to think, believe, and act according to their values.
- **Right to Protest:** Peacefully advocating for justice or ethical causes.
- **Protection from Discrimination:** Ensures equality and respect in society.

Responsibilities

- **Acting with Integrity:** Being honest, fair, and ethical in all actions.
- **Standing Against Injustice:** Reporting and opposing discrimination, corruption, or exploitation.
- **Helping Others:** Supporting vulnerable members of society, such as the poor or marginalized.

Types/Forms of Citizenship

1. Naturalization

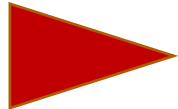
- Naturalization is the process through which a non-citizen legally becomes a citizen of a country.

Requirements for Naturalization (vary by country)

- **Residency:** Living in the country for a specific period (e.g., 5 years in the U.S.).
- **Language Proficiency:** Demonstrating knowledge of the country's official language(s).
- **Civic Knowledge:** Passing a test about the country's history, government, and values.
- **Good Moral Character:** Having no serious criminal record or history of dishonesty.

Examples

- A foreign national working in Canada for several years may apply for Canadian citizenship through naturalization.
- A refugee in Germany might gain citizenship after fulfilling residency and integration requirements.



Types/Forms of Citizenship

2. Dual Citizenship

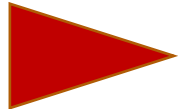
- Dual citizenship means holding citizenship in two countries simultaneously.

Key Points

- Allows individuals to enjoy the rights and privileges of both countries.
- May involve dual responsibilities, such as paying taxes or serving in the military for both nations.
- Not all countries allow dual citizenship (e.g., Japan requires renunciation of previous citizenship).

Example

- A person born in the U.K. to Pakistani parents might have dual citizenship in both Pakistan and the U.K.



Types/Forms of Citizenship

3. Global Citizenship

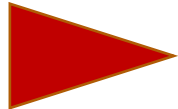
- Global citizenship refers to identifying as a member of the global community, emphasizing universal values, human rights, and shared responsibility for the planet.

Key Characteristics

- Awareness of global issues, such as climate change or poverty.
- Respect for cultural diversity and international cooperation.
- Advocacy for human rights and sustainable development.

Example

- Participating in international humanitarian projects or advocating for global environmental policies reflects global citizenship.



Types/Forms of Citizenship

4. Citizenship by Investment

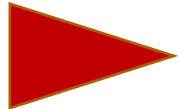
- Some countries allow individuals to gain citizenship by making significant financial investments in their economy.

Examples of Investments

- Buying real estate or government bonds.
- Donating to national development funds.

Countries Offering It

- Malta, Antigua and Barbuda, and St. Kitts and Nevis offer citizenship through investment programs.



Types/Forms of Citizenship

5. Digital Citizenship

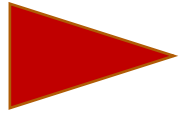
- Digital citizenship refers to responsible and ethical behavior when using digital technology and engaging online.

Key Elements

- Digital Rights: Freedom of expression, privacy, and access to information.
- Digital Responsibilities: Avoiding cyberbullying, respecting intellectual property, and protecting personal data.

Example

- Using social media responsibly by verifying information before sharing or reporting harmful content online.



Associated Concepts to Citizenship

Statelessness

A stateless person is someone who does not have citizenship in any country.

Causes of Statelessness

- Conflict in laws (e.g., children born to stateless parents).
- Discrimination (e.g., ethnic or religious groups being denied citizenship).
- Loss of citizenship due to political changes or administrative errors.

The Rohingya people in Myanmar face statelessness due to being denied citizenship.

Corporate Citizenship

Corporate citizenship refers to businesses acting responsibly toward society, focusing on social, environmental, and ethical impacts.

Key Practices

- Reducing environmental harm through sustainable practices.
- Supporting local communities through charitable activities.
- Promoting ethical labor practices and employee welfare.

A company investing in renewable energy or running education programs for underprivileged children.



Need Assessment: Guidelines for Choosing Your Project

1. Relevance to the Community

- Select an issue that directly affects your local community (e.g., neighborhood, university, city, or vulnerable groups).
- Make sure the project addresses a real and pressing need rather than a minor inconvenience.

2. Feasibility & Scope

- Choose a project that can realistically be completed within the semester.
- Consider the time, skills, and resources available to your team.
- Avoid overly broad issues (e.g., “global poverty”)—narrow it down to a specific and manageable focus (e.g., “access to clean drinking water in X neighborhood”).

3. Evidence-Based Need

- Base your choice on research, surveys, or interviews rather than assumptions.
- Use data and observations to prove the need exists and is important.



Need Assessment: Guidelines for Choosing Your Project

4. Impact & Value

- Think about who will benefit from the project and how.
- Choose something that can make a tangible difference, even if it's small but meaningful.

5. Innovation & Creativity

- Try to bring in new ideas, approaches, or solutions instead of repeating what has already been done many times.
- Creativity is encouraged, but keep it practical.

6. Ethical Considerations

- Respect the dignity, culture, and privacy of community members.
- Projects must not exploit participants or cause harm.



Need Assessment: Guidelines for Choosing Your Project

7. Team Interest & Skills

- Select a project your group feels motivated and passionate about.
- Leverage your team's strengths and academic background—for example, computer science students could work on tech-based solutions for community problems.

8. Alignment with Course Goals

- The project should connect with the course's aim: civic responsibility, social change, and community engagement.
- Your work should demonstrate both learning and social contribution.

